



PARTICIPANT BRIEFING • OCTOBER 9, 2026

AppBuildersPH Hackathon 2026

HOW IT WORKS

Event format

FRI, OCT 9 • REMOTE

Build Day

- Briefing at at 1:30 PM
- Building begins
- Build from anywhere, overnight

SAT, OCT 10 • IN PERSON

Demo Day

- Cyberzone, SM Makati
- 1:00 PM to 7:00 PM
- Finalists pitch live to the judges

A 24-hour hackathon, followed by an in-person Demo Day.

TODAY • OCTOBER 9

Build Day schedule

1:30 PM	Online room opens
1:45 PM	Participant briefing
2:00 PM	Official challenge reveal
2:10 PM	Rules and judging criteria
2:20 PM	Sponsor resources and credits
2:30 PM	Building begins
6:00 PM	Optional community check-in
10:00 PM	Optional community check-in

Teams continue building overnight.

1:00 PM • OFFICIAL REVEAL

The challenge

THE THEME

Local AI

Useful AI experiences where meaningful AI computation happens on the user's device, rather than depending entirely on cloud inference.

This is different from building an AI product for a local audience.

What counts as Local AI

Local LLMs

Local vision models

Local speech recognition

Local embeddings and RAG

Local AI agents

Local image generation

Edge AI

Offline AI

Privacy-preserving AI

Hybrid local + cloud systems

AI on PCs, laptops, phones, or edge hardware

Cloud services may be used, but meaningful AI functionality must run locally.

THE CHALLENGE

**Build an AI product that
remains genuinely useful
when the cloud disappears.**

THE CHALLENGE

What we're asking for

Create a working product that uses AI running locally on a user's device to solve a real problem.

Show why running AI locally creates an experience that would be difficult, expensive, slow, private, or impossible with a cloud-only approach.

ANY KIND OF PRODUCT

Productivity

Developer tools

Accessibility

Education

Finance

Gaming

Disaster response

Healthcare

Creative tools

Enterprise tools

Computer vision

Personal assistants

Privacy tools

Local agents

Rules

Required

- Substantially built during the hackathon
- A meaningful part of AI inference executes locally
- A working product, demonstrated
- Models, APIs, frameworks, and major tools disclosed
- Core Local AI functionality works without depending entirely on a cloud AI API

Allowed

- Existing open-source models and libraries
- AI-assisted development
- Devin
- Cloud APIs as secondary components

Tools you can use

Ollama

LM Studio

llama.cpp

MLX

ONNX

PyTorch

TensorFlow

WebGPU

Core ML

AMD ROCm

DirectML

Hugging Face

Plus open-source LLMs, vision models, and speech models. No specific model, framework, operating system, or hardware platform is required.

Teams

1-4

members per team

Solo

builders are allowed

Remote

work from anywhere
throughout October 9

Teams that want to be finalists must be present at Cyberzone, SM Makati for Demo Day on October 10.

Eligibility

Only participants listed on the official AppBuildersPH website are allowed to compete.

appbuildersph.com/hackathon

✓ **Allowed**

You can still change teams or your team name, as long as you submit your official team name and member names from the official website list.

⚠ **Disqualified**

- Members not on the official list
- Participants proven to have received external help from people outside the hackathon

HARD RULE

Results can be disputed

if a team is proven to have violated the rules, including but not limited to:



Pre-existing project



**Receiving external
help**



Fake benchmarks

HOW YOU'LL BE SCORED

Judging criteria

25%

Problem & Usefulness

Does it solve a genuine problem for a clear target user?

25%

Local AI Implementation

Is local inference fundamental, and does it give a meaningful advantage?

20%

Technical Execution

Does it actually work, reliably enough for a live demonstration?

15%

Innovation

Is it meaningfully different? Does Local AI enable something new?

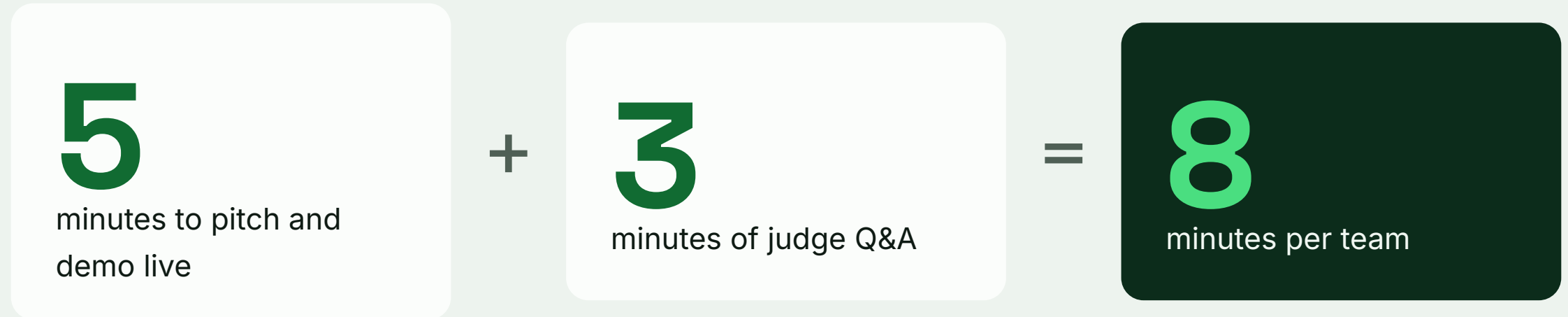
15%

Product & Demo Quality

Is the UX usable, and is the live demonstration convincing?

Half the score is usefulness and how real your Local AI is.

Pitch format



Finalists are announced on Demo Day, October 10 at 1:00 PM. Prioritize showing a working product over presenting a large number of slides.

WHAT TO SUBMIT

Submission checklist

The project

- Project name
- Short description
- Team members
- Public GitHub repository

The proof

- Demo video
- X / LinkedIn video URL
- What runs locally
- What requires internet

The disclosures

- Models used
- Technologies and frameworks
- APIs and cloud services
- Existing code and assets
- AI development tools

EVERY SUBMISSION MUST ANSWER

Why does this product benefit from running AI locally?

Submission deadline: 10:00 AM, October 10. No extensions.

WHAT YOU'RE BUILDING FOR

Prizes

Grand Champion

₱50,000

Best overall project

- Cash
- AMD / ASUS peripherals
- Devin AI credits

WhiteCloak Award

₱15,000

Cash · WhiteCloak merch

Cognition / Devin Award

₱10,000

Cash

AMD Award

₱10,000

Cash · AMD / ASUS
peripherals

People's Choice Award

₱10,000

Audience vote during Demo
Day
Cash

Tutorials Dojo Award

₱10,000

Four winners, ₱10,000 cash
each
Cash

Special awards may be
won independently of
the main award.

WHO YOU'RE PITCHING TO

Judges

10

judges

Announced on Demo Day, October 10.

THANK YOU

Sponsors



VENUE

CYBERZONE SM Makati

Demo Day schedule

12:00 PM	Registration and participant arrival
12:15 PM	Demo and AV technical checks
1:00 PM	Official opening and AppBuildersPH welcome
1:15 PM	PCExpress welcome
1:20 PM	AMD segment
1:30 PM	Cognition / Devin segment

1:40 PM	Finalist pitching begins
3:20 PM	Break and networking
3:40 PM	Finalist pitching continues
5:00 PM	Judging deliberation, PC Express auction and raffle
5:45 PM	Awards ceremony
6:30 PM	Networking
7:00 PM	Event ends

KEEP THESE OPEN

Links

OFFICIAL APPBUILDERS HACKATHON WEBSITE

appbuildersph.com/hackathon

HACKATHON PAGE

cerebralvalley.ai/e/appbuildersph-hackathon-2026

TELEGRAM GROUP CHAT

t.me/+uxlZLV5_jEZjMDNl

Rules and tools

Can we use cloud APIs?

Yes, as secondary components. Your core Local AI functionality must not depend entirely on a cloud AI API.

Can we use AI coding tools like Devin?

Yes. AI-assisted development and Devin are allowed. Disclose the tools you used.

Can we use open-source models and libraries?

Yes. Disclose every model, framework, and API in your submission.

Can we reuse code we wrote before today?

Your project must be substantially built during the hackathon. Disclose any existing code or assets.

Do we need a specific model, OS, or hardware?

No. Any model, framework, operating system, or hardware platform works.

Can people outside the hackathon help us?

No. Participants proven to have received external help from people outside the hackathon are disqualified.

Teams

Who can compete?

Only participants listed on the official website, appbuildersph.com/hackathon.

Can we change teams or our team name?

Yes, as long as you submit your official team name and member names from the official website list.

How big can a team be?

1 to 4 members is recommended. Solo builders are allowed.

Can one person join more than one team?

No. Each person can only be on one team.

Can a team submit more than one project?

No. One project per team.

Is there a limit on the number of teams?

No. There is no cap.

Build Day and videos

Can we build from anywhere?

Yes. Build Day is fully remote, and teams continue building overnight.

Where do we ask questions during the build?

Post in the official Telegram group chat.

How long should the demo video be?

Ideally around 1 minute.

Is the X or LinkedIn video post required?

Yes. Tag Devin / Cognition and include #AppBuildersPH.

What do we need to disclose?

Models, frameworks, APIs and cloud services, existing code and assets, and the AI development tools you used.

Can our project be a mobile app or run on hardware?

Yes.

Submissions

Where do we submit?

On the Cerebral Valley event page:
cerebralvalley.ai/e/appbuildersph-hackathon-2026.

When is the deadline?

10:00 AM, October 10. No extensions.

Can we edit or resubmit?

No. Each team submits only once, so check everything before you submit.

Does our GitHub repository need to be public?

Yes. It must be public by the 10:00 AM deadline.

Can we keep committing after the deadline?

No. Code freezes at 10:00 AM, and judges review the repository as of the deadline.

What must every submission answer?

Why does this product benefit from running AI locally?

Demo Day on site

When are finalists announced?

On Demo Day, October 10 at 1:00 PM.

Do we need to be at Demo Day?

Everyone is welcome. Teams that want to be a finalist must be at Cyberzone, SM Makati in person.

Can a team member pitch remotely?

No. Someone from your team must be on site to pitch and answer the judges' Q&A.

Will there be Wi-Fi, power, and display connections?

Yes. Wi-Fi, power outlets, and HDMI and USB-C are available. Bring your own laptop to demo on.

Will food be provided?

Yes. Coffee and sandwiches.

Can we bring guests?

Yes. Guests are welcome to watch the pitches.

Pitches and awards

How long is each pitch?

5 minutes to pitch and demo live, plus 3 minutes of judge Q&A.

How does People's Choice voting work?

People at Demo Day scan a QR code to vote. The same QR code scans are also used for the raffle.

Can one project win more than one award?

Yes. Special awards can be won independently of the main award.

How are cash prizes paid?

By bank transfer to an authorized representative from each winning team.

Do we keep ownership of what we build?

Yes. Your team keeps ownership of your project.

Can results be disputed?

Yes, if a team is proven to have violated the rules, including a pre-existing project, external help, or fake benchmarks.

Other questions

Does the app need to be deployed live?

No, as long as your repository has instructions for judges to recreate it.

What if a team member drops out?

Only the member names in your submission are counted.

How many finalists will there be?

10 to 15 finalist teams.

Will there be certificates of participation?

Yes, on the AppBuildersPH website.

Who do we contact with concerns on Demo Day?

Bryl Lim or any of the organizing members.

October 10, 2026 10:00 AM DE

Submission

cerebralvalley.ai/e/appbuildersph-hackathon-2026